The `_restore` endpoint copies data from the repository to the cluster. Of course, we can attach a JSON object to specify further details of which indexes or data streams we want to restore. The following query provides an example of such a request.

Listing 14.9 Restoring indexes from a snapshot

```
POST _snapshot/es_cluster_snapshot_repository/custom_prod_snapshots/_restore
{
  "indices":["new_movies"]
}
```

Lists the indexes to be restored from the snapshot

14.4.5 Deleting snapshots

We don't need to keep snapshots on disk all the time. One strategy most organizations follow is to create snapshots for individual indexes based on user requests. We may need to update our mapping or change the primary shards of a given index. Unfortunately, we can't do this as long as the index is in a live state.

The best approach is to create a new index with the appropriate shards and mapping and then take a snapshot of the current index, restore that to the newly created index from the snapshot, and delete the snapshot. Figure 14.12 shows this activity.

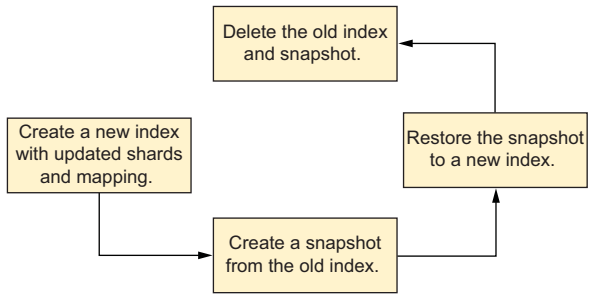


Figure 14.12 Snapshot lifecycle, from creation to deletion

We can migrate data from an old index to a new one with the snapshot and restore functionality. Once we use the snapshots, we can delete them to free up storage space.

Deleting snapshots is fairly straightforward: we use the HTTP `DELETE` action, providing the snapshot ID. The following listing deletes the snapshot we created earlier.

Listing 14.10 Deleting a snapshot

```
DELETE _snapshot/es_cluster_snapshot_repository/custom_prod_snapshots
```

If we issue the HTTP `DELETE` action command while the snapshot is in progress, Elasticsearch instantly halts the activity, deletes the snapshot, and removes the contents from the repository.

14.4.6 Automating snapshots

We've just seen the mechanism for creating snapshots, but these are ad hoc snapshots: we create them on demand (for example, when migrating data, rolling out a production hotfix release, etc.). However, we can automate this process to regularly back up